

143. In which one of the following regions was Dhanyakataka, which flourished as a prominent Buddhist centre under the Mahasanghikas, located?

- (a) Andhra (b) Gandhara
(c) Kalinga (d) Magadha

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Ans. (a)

Dhanyakataka (present day Dharnikota) is an ancient site located in present day Palnadu district in Andhra Pradesh. It was an important town in Deccan and the capital of later Satvahanas. It was a major center of Buddhist learning & culture. Excavation at Dharnikota has revealed viharas here and in nearby areas.

144. Which form of Buddhism was prominent during the Sultanate period?

- (a) Theravada (b) Hinayana
(c) Vajrayana (d) Tantrayana

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Ans. (c)

In the medieval period (Sultanate Period), Vajrayana sect of Buddhism was most prominent. Vajrayana mostly flourished in the 8th century A.D. The principles of Vajrayana is found in 'Arya Manjushrimulka' and 'Guhyasamaja'.

145. Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on :

- (a) Prajnaparamita Sutra (b) Visuddhimagga
(c) Sarvastivada Vinaya (d) Lalitavistara

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Ans. (c)

Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on Sarvastivada Vinaya, a significant text within the Sarvastivada school of Buddhism, which outlines the rules and regulations for monastic life. Sanghabhuti's commentary provided explanations and interpretations of the Vinaya rules, aiming to clarify and elaborate on the text for Chinese Buddhist practitioners. In its early history, the Sarvastivada Vinaya was the most common vinaya tradition in China.

Jain Religion

*Jain is derived from the Sanskrit word 'jin', which means the winner. *Founders of Jainism are called 'Tirthankara', while Jain Mahatmas are called 'Nirgranth'. *Jainism is considered to have a total of 24 Tirthankars who propagated Jainism from time to time. They are - 1. Rishabhdev or Adinath 2. Ajitnath, 3. Sambhavanath, 4. Abhinandan, 5. Sumatinath, 6. Padmaprab-

ha, 7. Suparshvanath, 8. Chandraprabha, 9. Pushpadant (Suvridhinath), 10. Sheetalnath, 11. Shreyansanath, 12. Vasupujya 13. Vimalnath, 14. Anantnath, 15. Dharmanath, 16. Shantinath, 17. Kunthunath 18. Aranath, 19. Mallinath, 20. Munisuvrata, 21. Naminath, 22. Neminath or Arishtanemi, 23. Parshvanath and 24. Mahavira Swami. *The first Tirthankara of Jainism was **Rishabhdev**. *His other names are Rishabhdev, Adinath and Vrishabhdev. *Rishabhdev and Arishtanemi are mentioned in the Rig Veda. *Parshvanath is the 23rd Tirthankara of Jainism. *He was born in Kashi (Varanasi). *His father, Ashwasen was the king of Kashi. *Parshvanath obtained Kaivalya (complete knowledge) in Ashrampad Udyan near Varanasi and he attained Parinirvana on the mount Sammed Shikhar or Sammet Shikhar. Parshvanath asked his followers to follow four restraints. These were - Ahimsa (Non-violence), Aparigraha (forgoing-possession), Asteya (not-stealing) and Satya (truth). **Mahavira Swami** was born in Kundagram near Vaishali about 599 BC. *His father **Siddhartha** was the chief of the Gyatrik Kshatriya Sangh. *His mother **Trishala or Videhdatta** was the sister of Chetaka, the head of Lichchhavi Republic. *Mahavira Swami's childhood name was **Vardhaman**. *His wife's name was **Yashoda** (daughter of Kundinya Gotra). They had a daughter named **Anojja (Priyadarshana)**. She was married to Jamali.

*The word '**Kaivalya**' is used for 'Complete knowledge' in Jain religion. Mahavira Swami obtained the Kaivalya (complete knowledge) under a tree of 'Sal' on the bank of Rijupalika river near Jrimbhik village. Therefore he is called Kevalin. After Kaivalya he was called Kevalin, Arhat (Yogya), Jin (Vijeta) and Nirgranth (Bandhan Rahit).

*After attaining Kaivalya, Mahavira Swami started propagating his principles. *Lichchhavi Chief of Vaishali, **Chetaka**, who was his uncle, made a major contribution in the promotion of Jainism. *Makkhali Gosala was a disciple of Mahavira in the early period, but later he fell out with Mahavira due to the difference of opinion and founded his own creed "Ajivika". The belief of the sect is known as '**Niyatiwad**' according to which every matter in the world is being controlled and operated by destiny (fate).

*In Jain philosophy, the people (e.g. monks) are very keen to uplift their souls and hence they sacrifice all worldly enjoyments and adopt five great 'Vratas' (vows) – **Ahimsa, Satya, Brahmacharya, Asteya** and **Aparigraha**. *These Mahavratas are difficult to practice by average human beings. So they follow **Anuvratas** i.e. Ahimsa Anuvrat, Satya Anuvrat, Brahmacharya Anuvrat, Asteya Anuvrat, and Aparigraha Anuvrat.

*Mahavira Swami was the 24th and the last Tirthankara of Jain religion. He denied the unmanliness of Vedas and opposed related social-cultural traditions. By leaving the exclusive belief of selfish and atheists, he accepted the middle path known as '**Syadvad**'. Syadvad is also known as the name of **Saptabhanginaya**, which means knowledge is relative.

Main Jain Tirthankar and their symbols –

Rishabhdev	Bull
Ajitanath	Elephant
Sambhavnath	Horse
Padmaprabha	Lotus
Suparshvanath	Sathiya (Swastik)
Mallinath	Kalash
Naminath	Nilkamal (Blue lotus)
Neminath	Shankha (conch)
Parshvanath	Serpent
Mahavira Swami	Lion

*Three means are said to be important for attaining ‘Moksha’ in Jain philosophy : **Right Belief, Right Conduct and Right knowledge**. These three are also called ‘**Ratnatraya**’ /Triratna in Jain Religion. Freedom from the bondage and effect of evil omens called Sanvar Tattva to make the spirit free from the bondage of all. The destruction of Karma is the Nirjara element. *When the remains of karma in the life are exhausted, then it attains ‘**Moksha**’. *‘**Anant Chattushtya**’ in Jainism is ‘Anant Gyan’ (infinite knowledge), ‘Anant Darshan’ (infinite perception), ‘Anant Virya’ (infinite power) and ‘Anant Anand’ (infinite bliss).

*Mahavira Swami established a Sangh during his lifetime. *There were 11 major followers in this Sangh. They were called ‘Ganadhar’. Their names are - Indrabhuti, Agnibhuti, Vayubhuti (three brothers), Arya Vyakta, Sudharma, Mandavya, Mauryaputra, Akampana, Achal, Metarya and Prabhasa. *After the death of Mahavira, Sudharma became the first president of Jain Sangha. *After the death of Sudharma, Jambu remained the president of Sangh for 44 years. *At the time of the last Nand Ruler, Sambhutavijay and Bhadrabahu were the presidents of Sangha. These two were the last people to know about the ancient Jain texts of the 14 Purvas given by Mahavira. *After Lord Mahavira’s departure, when Bhadrabahuswami was the head of the religious order and the Nand dynasty was ruling over Magadha, Pataliputra the capital city became the centre of learning and knowledge. At that time, there occurred a severe famine that seems to have raged for 12 long years. During that period of shortage and scarcity, it was hard for Jain monks to observe the code of conduct laid down by the Lord. Bhadrabahuswami, therefore, decided to migrate to the South along with many followers. For those who stayed behind, it was hard to remember accurately whatever they learnt. Venerable Sthulabhadra and most of those who stayed in the north used to cover their bodies with a plain, white cloth; while those who had migrated with Bhadrabahuswami were mostly unclad. The latter took pride in their being true unclad followers of the Lord and in due course came to be known as **Digamabars** which means skyclad. Those on the other side came to be known as **Shwetambars** on account of white cloths that they wore.

*First Jain Sabha was held in **Pataliputra** in the fourth century

(310 BC) presided by **Sthulbhadra**. In this meeting, 12 Angas of Jainism were compiled. The followers of Bhadrabahu did not participate in this council. *The second Jain assembly was held in the sixth century (512 AD) in **Vallabhi** and was presided by Devardhigani Kshamashraman. In the second Jain Sabha, a compilation of 12 Angas, 12 Upanga, 10 Prakirna, 6 Chedsutras, 4 Mulsutra, **2 Chulikasutra** were compiled.

*Jain literature is called ‘Aagam’ (Principle). It consists of 12 Angas, 12 Upanga, 10 Prakiran, 6 Chedsutras, 4 Mulsutra, 2 Chulikasutra. The twelve Angas have an important place in Jain Agam. These are Acharanga-Sutra, Sutratkanga, Sthananga, Samavayanga, Bhagavati Vyakhyaprajnapiti, Jnatrdharmakatha, Upasakadasah, Antakrddasah, Anuttaraupapatikadasah, Prasnavyakarana, Vipaksruta and Dristivada. *There is a related ‘Upanga’ of every 12 Anga. These include the description of the universe, classification of beings, astronomy, time division, description of posthumous life etc. *10 Prakirna are the supplement to major texts.

*There are 6 ‘Chedsutra’. These contain a compilation of rules of Jain monks. Six Chedsutra are- Jitakalpa, Brihatkalpa, Nishith, Mahanishith, Vyavhar (Behavior) and Aachar Dasha. There are four Mulsutra. These contain sermons of Jainism, life in the forest, duties of the monks, rules of Yam, etc. *The four Mulsutra are - Dashvaikalik, Utaradhyayan, Avshayak and Pindniryukti or Pakshik Sutra.

*The two Chulikasutras (Nandi-sutra and Anuyogadwara-Sutra) are independent texts of Jains, which are a kind of encyclopedia

*In these texts moral stories have been written for monks. *In the Jain literature, the Grandson of Ashoka, Samprati, is described as the patron of Jainism. *Ujjain became a major centre of Jain religion during his rule. *The second major centre of Jains was Mathura. Many temples, statues, records, etc. have been found here.

*Kharwel the Chedi ruler of Kalinga was the great patron of Jain religion. *He built Vihars for the residence of Jain monks by cutting down the hills of Udaygiri and Khandagiri near Bhubaneswar. *Khajuraho’s temples are related to Hindu religion and Jainism.

*Dilawara Jain temple of Mount Abu is made of marble. Vimal Vasahi is the most prominent temple among the magnificent Jain Dilwara temples. *It was built by the Samanta Vimalshah of Chalukya (Solanki) ruler Bhimdev I of Gujarat. *Shravanabelagola is situated in the state of Karnataka. *During the reign of Gang ruler Rachamalla IV (Panchamalla), Prime minister named Chamundaraya built a huge Jain statue of **Bahubali (Gomateshwar)** in 981 A.D. Bahubali, is considered the son of Rishabhdev, the first Tirthankar. ***Mahamastak-abhishek** is an important festival of Jainism, which is held at Shravanabelagola in Karnataka State every 12 years.

The difference between Shwetambaras and Digambaras	
Shwetambara	Digambara
• People of this community wear white clothes. • According to this philosophy, attainment of liberation (Moksha) is possible for a woman. • People of this sect believe in taking food after attaining enlightenment. • According to this opinion, Mahavira Swami was married. • According to this opinion, the 19th Tirthankara Malinath was a woman.	• The people of this sect are completely naked and perform austerity (Tapsya). • According to this opinion, salvation (Moksha) is not possible for a woman. • While Digambar is against it. • According to Digambar, Mahavira Swami was unmarried. • The 19th Tirthankara, Malinath was man according to Digambara.

Other Jain texts and their composers	
Jain texts	Composers
Kalpasutra	Bhadrabahu
Parishisht Parvan	Hemchandra
Syadvadmanjari	Mallisen
Dravya Sangrah	Nemichandra
Tatvarth Sutra	Umaswami
Nyayavtar	Shidhsen Diwakar
Nyaya Deepika	Dharmabhusan
ShlokVartik	Vidyanand Swami
Panchvinshatika	Padmanandi
Pravachansar	Kundkund

1. The originator of the Jain religion is –
- (a) Arya Sudharma (b) Mahavira Swami
(c) Parshwanath (d) Rishabh Dev

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (d)

First Tirthankara Rishabhdev or Aadinath is known as the originator of Jain religion. Mahavira Swami was the 24th Tirthankar of Jain religion, who propagated the Jain philosophy during the 6th Century B.C.

2. Who was the first Tirthankara of Jain religion ?

- (a) Parsvanath (b) Rishabhanath
(c) Mahavira (d) Chetaka
(e) Trisala

Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Parshvanatha, the Jain 'Thirthankara' was associated mainly with which of the following places?

- (a) Varanasi (b) Kaushambi
(c) Giribraja (d) Champa

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

Lord Parshvanath was 23rd Tirthankara of Jain Religion. He was born in Varanasi and was the son of King Aswasena and Queen Vama of Varanasi. He obtained Kaivalya (complete knowledge) in Ashrampad Udyan near Varanasi and he attained Parinirvan on the Mount Sammed Shikhar or Sammeta.

4. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List-I (Tirthankara)	List-II (Cognizance)
A. Adinatha	1. Bull
B. Mallinatha	2. Horse
C. Parshavanatha	3. Snake
D. Sambhavnatha	4. Water Jar

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 1	4	3	2
(b) 1	3	2	4
(c) 2	4	3	1
(d) 3	1	4	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched list is as follows –

(Tirthankaras)	(Cognizance)
Adinatha	- Bull
Mallinatha	- Water Jar
Parshvanatha	- Snake
Sambhavnatha	- Horse

5. Match list-I with list-II and choose the correct answer from the code given below –

List-I (Tirthankara)	List-II (Their cognition)
A. Parshvanath	(i) Bull
B. Adinath	(ii) Lion
C. Mahaveer	(iii) Snake
D. Shantinath	(iv) Deer

Code -

- (a) A-(ii), B-(iii), C-(iv), D-(i)
- (b) A-(iv), B-(iii), C-(ii), D-(i)
- (c) A-(i), B-(ii), C-(iii), D-(iv)
- (d) A-(iii), B-(i), C-(ii), D-(iv)

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (d)

The correctly matched list is as follows -

List-I	List-II
(Tirthankara)	(Their cognition)
Parshvanath	Snake
Adinath	Bull
Mahavira	Lion
Shantinath	Deer

6. Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

(Tirthankar) - (Nirvan Place)

- (a) Rishabhanath - Ashtapad
- (b) Vasupujya - Sammedashikhar
- (c) Neminath - Urjayanta
- (d) Mahavira - Pavapuri

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (b)

Vasupujya was the 12th Tirthankar of Jainism. He attained Nirvana or Moksha in Champapur (Bihar). All other pairs are correctly matched.

7. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
(Place)	(Related Tirthankar)
A. Shravasti	1. Rishabhanath
B. Kakandi	2. Padmaprabhu
C. Ayodhya	3. Suvidhanath
D. Pabhosa	4. Sambhavnath

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 3	1	2	4
(b) 2	4	1	3
(c) 4	3	1	2
(d) 3	2	4	1

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (c)

Correct match is as follows :

List-I	List-II
(Place)	(Related Tirthankar)
Shravasti	Sambhavnath
Kakandi	Suvidhinath (Pushpadant)
Ayodhya	Rishabhanath
Pabhosa	Padmaprabhu

8. Consider the following 'Tirthankara' and arrange them in chronological order:

I. Abhinandan

II. Vimal Nath

III. Munishubhratha Nath

IV. Padmaprabhu

Select the correct answer from the code given below.

Code :

- (a) I, IV, II and III
- (b) III, I, II and IV
- (c) IV, III, I and II
- (d) IV, I, III and II

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

Abhinandana Natha was 4th Tirthankara, Padmaprabhu was 6th Tirthankara, Vimal Nath was 13th and Munishuvrata Nath was 20th Tirthankara.

9. Where was Mahavira Swami born?

- (a) Kundagram
- (b) Pataliputra
- (c) Magadha
- (d) Vaishali

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Mahavira Swami was born in Kundagram (Kundalpur) near Vaishali in approx 599 BC. His mother Trishala was the sister of Chetak, the head of the Lichchhavi republic, and his father Siddhartha was the head of Gyatrik Kshatriya. Nandivardhan was his elder brother.

10. Kundalpur is the birthplace of -

- (a) Emperor Ashoka
- (b) Gautam Buddha
- (c) Mahavira Swami
- (d) Chaitanya Mahaprabhu

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

11. The salvation place of Mahavirji, the originator of Jain religion, is located at -:

- (a) Maner
- (b) Rajgir
- (c) Pavapuri
- (d) Jalan Port
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

Mahavira Swami was born in Kundagram near Vaishali in 599 BC. He attained Nirvana at the age of (approx) 72 years in 527 BC in Pavapuri, located near Rajgriha (Rajgir).

12. Mahavira Jain breathed his last at –

- (a) Rajgir (b) Sanchi
(c) Pavapuri (d) Samastipur

45th B.P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

13. What is not true in relation to Vardhamana Mahavir?

- (a) He is considered to be 24th and last Tirthankara
(b) His mother was sister of Licchavi's king Chetaka
(c) He did not marry in this lifetime
(d) He left his body in 527 BCE at Pavapuri near Patna

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Mahavira Swami was born in Kundagram near Vaishali in about 599 BC. His father Siddhartha was the chief of the Gyatrik Kshatriya Sangh. His mother Trishala was the sister of Chetka, the head of Lichchhavi Republic. His wife's name was Yashoda. He was the 24th and the last Tirthankara of Jain religion. He attained Nirvana at the age of (approx) 72 years in 527 BC in Pavapuri, located near Patna.

14. The word Tirthankara is related to –

- (a) Buddhists (b) Christians
(c) Hindus (d) Jains

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

The term Tirthankara is related to Jain Religion. It is known that there were 24 Thirthankara who contributed to Jain religion and who propagated Jain philosophy from time to time. These are - (1) Rishabhath (2) Ajitnath, (3) Sambhath, (4) Abhinandannath, (5) Sumatinath, (6) Padmaprabha, (7) Suparshvanath, (8) Chandraprabha, (9) Suvidhinatha, (10) Sheetalanath (11) Shreyanshnath, (12) Vasupujya (13) Vimalnath (14) Anantnath (15) Dharmanath (16) Shantinath, (17) Kunthunath, (18) Aranath, (19) Mallinath, (20) Munisuvrata, (21) Naminatha, (22) Arishtanemi, (23) Parshvanath, (24) Mahavira Swami.

15. Who was the last one in the order of Jain Tirthankaras?

- (a) Parshvanath (b) Risabhdev
(c) Mahavira (d) Manisuvrata

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

16. Which one of the following was not a Jain Tirthankara?

- (a) Chandraprabhu (b) Nathamuni

(c) Nemi

(d) Sambhav

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

17. Prabhasgiri is a pilgrim spot of :

- (a) Buddhists (b) Jains
(c) Saivites (d) Vaishnavites

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Prabhasgiri is a Jain pilgrimage site located in Kaushambi, U.P. The site Prabhasgiri is related to 6th Jain Tirthankar, Padmaprabha.

18. In Jain Religion, which word is used for 'Complete Intellect'?

- (a) Jin (b) Ratna
(c) Kaivalya (d) Nirvana

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

The word 'Kaivalya' is used for 'Complete knowledge' in the Jain religion. Mahavira Swami obtained Kaivalya (complete knowledge) under a tree of 'Sal' on the bank of Rijupalika river near Jrimbhik village, after the rough austerity and practice of 12 years. Therefore he is called 'Kevlin.'

19. On the banks of which river did Mahavira Swami attain enlightenment?

- (a) Swarnasikta (b) Palashini
(c) Ganga (d) Rijupalika

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (d)

Mahavir Swami attained enlightenment at the bank of river Rijupalika in the village of Jrimbhik.

20. The doctrine of three jewels-Right faith, Right action and Right Knowledge, is the crowning glory of :

- (a) Buddhism (b) Christianity
(c) Jainism (d) None of these

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Three means are said to be important for 'Moksha' in Jain philosophy: Right faith, Right action and Right knowledge. These are known as 'Triratna' in Jain religion. Freedom from the bondage and effect of evil omens is called Sanvar Tattva to make the spirit free from the bondage of all. The destruction of Karma is the Nirjara element.

21. Triratna or Three Jewels, i.e., right knowledge, right faith and right action are related to which of the following?

- (a) Buddhism (b) Hinduism
(c) Jainism (d) Christianity
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

22. Which philosophy accepts 'Triratna'?

- (a) Buddhism (b) Nyaya philosophy
(c) Yoga philosophy (d) Jainism
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (*)

The concept of Triratna is present in both Buddhism as well as Jainism. In Buddhism, the three jewels are the Buddha, the Dhamma and the Sangha. In Jainism, they are Samyag-darshana, Samyagjnan and Samyagcharitra.

23. The correct of Anuvrata was advocated by :

- (a) Mahayana Buddhism (b) Hinayana Buddhism
(c) Jainism (d) The Lokayata school

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

In Jain philosophy, the persons (e.g. monks) are very keen to uplift their souls and hence they sacrifice all worldly enjoyments and adopt five great 'Vratas' (vows) – Mahavratas ; Ahimsa, Satya, Brahmacharya, Asteya and Aparigraha.

These Mahavratas are difficult to practise by average human beings. So they follow Anuvratas i.e. Ahimsa Anuvrat, Satya Anuvrat, Brahmacharya Anuvrat, Asteya Anuvrat, and Aparigraha Anuvrat.

24. Syadvad is a doctrine of –

- (a) Lokayatism (b) Saivism
(c) Jainism (d) Vaishnavism

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Mahavira Swami was the 24th Tirthankara of Jain religion. He denied the unmanliness of Vedas and opposed related social-cultural traditions and humbugs. By leaving the exclusive belief of selfists and atheists, he accepted the middle path known as 'Syadvad'. Syadvad is also known as the name of Saptabhanginaya, which means knowledge is relative.

25. 'Syadvada' is related to

- (a) Charvaka (b) Jaina
(c) Bauddha (d) Samkhya

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

26. Which of the following Doctrines are associated with Jainism?

- (i) Anekantavada (ii) Sarvastivada
(iii) Sunyavada (iv) Syadvada

Select the correct answer using the code given below –

- (a) (i) and (iv) (b) (ii) and (iv)
(c) (i), (ii) and (iii) (d) (ii) and (iii)

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (a)

Anekantvada and Syadvada are related to Jainism while Sunyavada and Sarvastivada are related to Buddhism.

27. The Jain philosophy holds that the world is created and maintained by

- (a) Universal Law (b) Universal Truth
(c) Universal Faith (d) Universal Soul

I.A.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

As per Jain belief, universal law is the essential and real form of the universe. The universe and all its substances are eternal (everlasting). All substances gradually change. Previous forms give way to new ones without losing their inherent qualities. Jains believe that the universe is without beginning or end. The universe did not begin and end at any time. There is no need for some almighty to create or manage the affairs of the universe. The universe runs on itself according to its cosmic laws (laws of nature).

28. Anekantavada is a core theory and philosophy of which one of the following

- (a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
(c) Sikhism (d) Vaishnavism

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

Anekantavada is the core theory and philosophy of Jainism. it is a metaphysical concept of Jain philosophy.

29. Consider the following statements about Jaina Philosophy.

- (1) The Jaina philosophy revolves around two main doctrines, i.e., Anekantavada and Syadvada.
(2) According to anekantavada, every being has numerous properties. The permanent property that constitutes the nature of a thing is called attribute (guna).

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) (1) only (b) (2) only
(c) Both (1) and (2) (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

The Jain philosophy revolves around two main doctrines, i.e., Anekantavada and 'Syadvada'. Both are extremely connected doctrines. According to Anekantavada, every being has numerous properties. The permanent property that constitutes the nature of a thing is called attribute (guna). The accidental property is called mode (Paryaya). According to syadvada, our knowledge is partial and relative because passion, anger, greed, etc., obstruct our knowledge. But we deem our partial and relative knowledge as complete and absolute.

30. According to Jain philosophy, the characteristics of Tattva are—

- (a) Origination (b) Decay
(c) Permanence (d) All of the above

Chhattisgarh PCS (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

Jain philosophy defines reality (Tattva) in terms of origination, decay and permanence (Nityata) or as attributes and modifications. Origination and decay are not separate phenomena but rather changes in form. Permanence refers to essential attributes and characteristics that remain constant. Thus, reality (Tattva) consists of both change and permanence. Jain philosophy states that an entity is real (Sat) when it possesses both permanence and transformation.

31. Which of the following religions does not trust in the concept of 'final annihilation of the world'?

- (a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
(c) Hinduism (d) Islam

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

As per Jainism, the Universe and all its substances are eternal. There is no concept of 'final annihilation of the world'.

32. The Basic point of Jainism is-

- (a) Act (b) Loyalty
(c) Non-violence (d) Disfavour

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

Jainism is also known as the religion of Ahimsa (non-violence). Ahimsa supersedes all concepts, ideologies, rules, customs and practices. Ahimsa, Anekantvad and Aparigraha are the cardinal principles of Jainism.

33. Yapaniya was the sect of-

- (a) Buddhist (b) Jainism
(c) Shaivists (d) Vaishnavists

U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Yapaniya was a sect of Jain religion; which is believed to have originated from Digambaras. However, they also used to follow certain Shwetambar opinions. The Yapaniyas worshipped nude images of the Tirthankaras in their temples.

34. With reference to the religious practices in India, the "Sthanakvasi" sect belongs to

- (a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
(c) Vaishnavism (d) Shaivism

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Sthanakvasi is a sect of Shwetambara Jainism. This sect originated from its predecessor reformist sect 'Lonka' which was founded by Lonkasha. It believes that idol worship is not essential in the path of soul purification and attainment of Nirvana.

35. Which of the following is the earliest holy book of Jain?

- (a) Twelve Angas (b) Twelve Upangas
(c) Fourteen Purvas (d) Fourteen Uppurva

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

The Fourteen Purvas is the ancient Jain scripture, which was preached by all Tirthankaras. At the time of the last Nand Ruler, Sambhutavijay and Bhadrabahu were the presidents of the Sangha. These two were the last to possess knowledge about the ancient Jain texts 14 purvas given by Mahavira.

36. In which one of the following languages was the earliest Jain literature compiled?

- (a) Ardha-Magadhi (b) Paali
(c) Prakrit (d) Sanskrit

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

All the initial religious Jain literature has been written in the Ardha-Magadhi. Its twelve Angas are in 'Ardha-Magadhi.' These holy books were finally compiled in the sixth century A.D. at Vallabhi near Gujarat.

37. Which of the following place is known as a place of Pilgrimages because of being related to Parshvanath?

- (a) Champa (b) Pava
(c) Sammed Shikhar (d) Urjyant

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Parshvanatha was the 23rd Tirthankara of Jainism. Parshvanatha was born to King Aswasena and Queen Vama of Varanasi in 850 BC. He belonged to the Ikshvaku dynasty. He lived as the formal prince of Varanasi and at the age of thirty, he renounced the world to become a monk. He meditated for 84 days before attaining Kaivalya Jnana. He achieved Parinirvana at Sammed Shikhar that's why this place is also known as a place of pilgrimage for Jains.

38. Which one of the following is not a part of early Jain literature?

- (a) Therigatha (b) Acarangasutra
(c) Suttrakritanga (d) Brihatkalpasutra

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The Therigatha is a Buddhist scripture in which the early nuns (bhikshunis) recount their struggles and accomplishments along the road to spiritual attainment. Their stories are told with often heart-breaking honesty and beauty, revealing the deeply human side of these extraordinary women and thus serve as inspiring reminders of our potential to follow in their footsteps. Rest are the part of Jain scriptures.

39. Who was the first founder of Shwetambar creed during the first partition of Jain creed?

- (a) Sthulabhadra
(b) Bhadrabahu
(c) Kalakacharya
(d) Deverdhi Kshama Sharaman

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

About 150 years after Lord Mahavira's departure, when Bhadrabahuswami was the head of the religious order and Nand dynasty was ruling over Magadha. Pataliputra the capital city became the centre of learning and knowledge. At that time there occurred a severe famine that seems to have raged for 12 long years. During that period of shortage and scarcity, it was hard for Jain monks to observe the code of conduct laid down by the Lord. Bhadrabahuswami, therefore, decided to migrate to the South along with many followers. For those who stayed behind, it was hard to remember accurately whatever they learnt. Venerable Sthulabhadra and most of those who stayed in the north used to cover their bodies with a plain, white cloth; while those who had migrated with Bhadrabahuswami were mostly unclad. The latter took pride in their being true unclad followers of the Lord and in due course came to be known as Digamabars which means skyclad. Those on the other side came to be known as Shwetamabars on account of white cloth that they wore.

40. The first disciple of Lord Mahavir was –

- (a) Jamali (b) Yashoda
(c) Bipin (d) Prabhash

Ans. (a)

Among the early visitors to Mahavira during his wandering was Jamali, his son-in-law. Jamali met Mahavira while the latter was in Kshatriya- Kundagram, the village where Mahavira was born. He took the vow together with five hundred of the warrior caste. Jamali was the first disciple of Lord Mahavira.

41. Who was the first follower of Mahavira?

- (a) Jamali (b) Yashoda
(c) Aanooja (d) Trishala

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

42. Svetambara Agama was finally edited at the Jain Council of –

- (a) Vaishali (b) Balabhi
(c) Pawa (d) Pataliputra

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

In the reign of Chandragupta Maurya, 1st Jain Council was held in which Shwetambara Agama were edited. Since all the ancient Jain text got destroyed, so to recompile them another Jain council was organised in 4th century BC in which followers of Bhadrabahu did not participate.

43. In which of the following place the first Jain Council was held?

- (a) Patliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Mathura (d) Ujjain

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

44. Read the following statements related to Jaina Literature and choose the appropriate option:

Statement I : The Shvetambara Canon included the 12 Angas

Statement II: According to Shvetambara tradition, the Angas were compiled at a council held at Vallabhi

- (a) Statement I and Statement II both are true
(b) Statement I is false, but Statement II is true
(c) Statement I and Statement II both are false
(d) Statement I is true, but Statement II is false

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The Shwetambara Canon includes 12 Angas. These are Canonical traits of Jainism based on Mahavira's teaching. Their compilation happened at 1st council held at Patliputra about 310 BC. Hence option (d) is correct.

45. Consider the following statements :

1. Vardhamana Mahavira's mother was the daughter of Lichchhavi King Chetaka
2. Gautama Buddha's mother was a princess from the Koliyan dynasty
3. Parshvanatha, the twenty-third Tirthankara, belonged to Banaras

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

Mahavira was born in 599 BC in a village named Kundagram near Vaishali in Bihar. Mahavira's original name was **Vardhamana**. His father Siddhartha was the head of the Gyatrika Kshatriya clan under Vajji of Vaishali and his mother Trishala was the sister of Chetaka, the king of Lichchhavi. Mahavira was also related to Bimbisara, the ruler of Magadha who married Chellana, the daughter of Chetaka. Lord Gautam Buddha's mother Maya, Suddhodana's wife, was a Koliya princess. Parshvanatha was born to King Aswasena and Queen Vama of Varanasi.

46. With reference to ancient Jainism, which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) Jainism was spread in South India under the leadership of Sthulabhadra
(b) The Jains who remained under the leadership of Bhadrabahu were called Shvetambaras after the Council held at Pataliputra
(c) Jainism enjoyed the patronage of the Kalinga king Kharavela in the first century BC
(d) In the initial stage of Jainism, the Jainas worshipped image unlike Buddhist

I.A.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Option (c) is the correct answer. Bhadrabahu spread Jainism in South India. Their followers are called Digambaras. Kalinga King Kharavela was the follower of Jainism. He gave patronage to Jain Monks and donated for their livelihood.

47. Which of the following statements is/are applicable to Jaina Doctrine?

1. The surest way of annihilating karma is to practice penance.
2. Every object, even the smallest particle has a soul.
3. Karma is the bane of the soul and must be ended.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) Only 1 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 2 (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

Jainism believes that each object even a particle has a soul. They also uphold the universal law of Karma. According to this law, every action - thought, word or deed - produces an effect which in turn serves as the cause of another action and so on. This chain of cause and effect is known as Karma. It follows that the state of the soul at any given time is due to the Karma accumulated over countless ages. Karma not only encompasses the causality of transmigration but is also conceived as an extremely subtle matter which infiltrates the soul obscuring its natural, transparent and pure qualities. Based on its karma, a soul undergoes transmigration and reincarnates in various states of existence like heaven or hell, or as humans or animals.

48. "Samadhi Maran" is related to which Philosophy?

- (a) Buddhist Philosophy
(b) Jain Philosophy
(c) Yoga Philosophy
(d) Lokayat Philosophy
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Samadhi Maran, Sallekhana and Sanyasna Maran is the last vow prescribed by Jain ethical code of conduct. The vow of Samadhi Maran is observed by Jain ascetics and lay votaries at the end of their lives by gradually reducing the intake of food and liquid. It is allowed when normal life is not possible due to old age, incurable disease, or when a person is nearing his end.

49. Consider the following statements:

1. The Ikshvaku rulers of Southern India were antagonistic towards Buddhism.
2. The Pala rulers of Eastern India were Patrons of Buddhism.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 or 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

During 3rd and 4th century Ikshvaku dynasty ruled over southern India. Though Ikshvakus of southern India followed a Vedic religion but also supported the Buddhist religion. Bengal emerged as the prominent nucleus of Buddhism during Pala dynasty. It was due to the support of Pala reign behind Buddhist. Thus, statement (I) is wrong while statement (II) is correct.

50. 'Ajivika' sect was founded by:

- (a) Anand (b) Rahulabhadra
(c) Makkhali Gosala (d) Upali

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Makkhali Gosala was a disciple of Mahavira in the early period, later fell out with Mahavira due to the difference of opinion with him. Although, various sources mention Ajivika scholars like Nanda Vaccha and Kisa Samkicca even before Makkhali Gosala, he is attributed to popularising the sect for first time. The belief of the sect is known as 'Niyatiwad' according to which every matter in the world is being controlled and operated by destiny (fate).

51. Who founded the Ajivika sect?

- (a) Makkhali Gosala (b) Vasubandhu
(c) Upagupta (d) Dignaga

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

52. Who among these rendered that "Fate assigns everything, human is incapable."

- (a) Jains (b) Buddhists
(c) Ajivikas (d) Mimansakas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

53. The sect which believed in abiding nature of destiny:

- (a) Jainism (b) Ajivikas
(c) Charvaka (d) Buddhism

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2013

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

54. Consider the following statements regarding the Ajivika sect:

1. Belief in determinism
2. The order of reincarnation can be changed.
3. Belief in austerity.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) Only 1 is correct. (b) Only 2 is correct.
(c) 1 and 2 are correct. (d) 1 and 3 are correct.
(e) Question not attempted.

Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

The Ajivika sect, which is an ancient religious and philosophical tradition of India, believes in determinism (fatalism). According to this belief, all events that occur in a person's life—both joys and sorrows—are preordained and governed by an unchangeable cosmic order. They held that

the universe follows a strict, predetermined course, where everything happens due to past conditions, and there is no scope for individual free will or moral efforts to change one's fate. They practised severe austerities, such as remaining silent for long periods and fasting, as they believed these acts were part of their predestined path. Because they did not believe in free will or individual effort, they also rejected the idea that one's rebirth cycle could be altered by personal or religious actions. Thus, it is clear that statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 is incorrect.

55. Consider the following about Ajivika sect :

- A. Makhali Gosala was its most important leader.
B. Central idea of the philosophy was "NIYATI" that is fate.
C. The discrimination on the basis of caste and class.
D. The Ajivikas had regular sabhas for meetings.

- (a) B, C and D are correct
(b) A, B and D are correct
(c) A and D are correct
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

Makkhali Gosala, a contemporary of Mahavira and Gautama Buddha, was the most prominent leader of the Ajivika sect. The Ajivikas' philosophy centered on "Niyati" (fate or destiny), emphasizing that life is entirely predetermined, leaving no room for free will. The Ajivikas were egalitarian and rejected the rigid caste and class system of their time. They also organized regular sabhas (meetings) as part of their community practices, making statements A, B and D correct, and Option (b) the right choice.

56. "Souls are not only the property of animal and plant life, but also of rocks, running water and many other natural objects not looked on as living by other religious sects."

The above statement reflects one of the core beliefs of which one of the following religious sects of ancient India?

- (a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
(c) Shaivism (d) Vaishnavism

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Under the Jain tradition, it is believed that there is an element inherent in all living beings, which is called soul. Jain acharya, Gurudev Chitrabhanu writes that "the universe is not for humanity alone; it is a field of evolution for all living beings." There are souls in non-mobile bodies, such as earth, water, fire, air and plants. According to Jainism, the soul resides in every particle of the world.